

was that users could now reply to messages directly from the notifications instead of moving to the Messages app. Another option is to delete emails from the notifications menu directly as well. This functionality is built into the OS' core systems and opens up the options to other app developers as well. The Twitter app, for instance, could enable users to directly respond to a tweet from the notifications panel, or Facebook could allow users to like an update on their posts within a pop-up notification. The ability to use the notifications to respond without having to switch between apps makes the new iOS far more open than ever before. Definitely a lot more convenient, too.

The Today view in the Notification Centre adds more to the functionality of this feature. Real time app updates can be used via widgets in the Today view such as those from weather apps or stock quotes. The layout is simplified to "Today" and "Notifications" with the removal of the "Missed" tab.

The Control Center

The Control Center was a new addition with the iOS 7 and has proven to be a major feature in terms of popularity and usage. In iOS 8 however this panel remains pretty much the same with only a few cosmetic changes here and there. The design has improved a bit with clearer icons, distinct on/off styles for buttons and a contrasted colour scheme. The only noticeable change is that when we adjust screen brightness the Control Center uniforms its luminance to let us get a clearer picture of the changes made.

The secondary changes to Control Center are related to active or related apps. The most significant among which is the iTunes Radio's "Buy" option. This option shows up at the right of the track playing information and lets users buy the track from the store with a touch. The panel display also shows how many skips are remaining on the iTunes Radio play but beyond which it remains pretty much the same.

Spotlight Search

It's hard to find stuff when you have a large amount of content synced to your phone and this is where Spotlight Search has always come in handy within the confines of the device. But with the new iOS 8 system it has been boosted both in the range of its coverage as well as the speed of its results. Although most of the features on Spotlight search are restricted to the United States region, it is no less powerful to help you search and navigate